



The Suffix -ness

I can add -ness to make a new word.



Today I am learning to:

- ☐ understand what -ness means
- ☐ add -ness to base words
- ☐ read and use new words
- ☐ use the words in sentences

1 Learn the Rule

The suffix **-ness** means **the state, quality or condition of something**.
When we add **-ness** to a base word, we make a new noun that shows a state or quality.

-ness = the state, quality or condition of something



happiness
the state of being happy



sadness
the state of being sad



brightness
the quality of being bright



kindness
the quality of being kind



safeness
the state of being safe



readiness
the state of being ready

2 Add -ness

Write the new word.

1. happy happi_____ 

2. kind kind_____ 

3. sad sad_____ 

4. bright bright_____ 

5. safe safe_____ 

6. ready ready_____ 

7. dark dark_____ 

8. sleepy sleep_____ 

3 Match the Meaning

Draw a line to match each word with its meaning.

happiness	•	•	the state of being ready
sadness	•	•	the quality of being kind
kindness	•	•	the state of being safe
brightness	•	•	the state of being happy
safeness	•	•	the state of being sad
readiness	•	•	the quality of being bright

4 Choose the Correct Word

Tick (✓) the word that makes sense.

- | | | |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. Her _____ made everyone smile. | ☐ happiness | ☐ kindness |
| 2. It was very _____ in the room. | ☐ darkness | ☐ brightness |
| 3. We need to be _____ for the trip. | ☐ safeness | ☐ readiness |
| 4. He showed great _____ to others. | ☐ sadness | ☐ kindness |
| 5. I felt _____ when I lost my toy. | ☐ happiness | ☐ sadness |
| 6. Wear a helmet for your _____. | ☐ safeness | ☐ brightness |

5 Use the Words

Write a sentence for each picture using a word with **-ness**.

1.  _____

2.  _____

3.  _____

Word Bank

happiness sadness kindness
brightness safeness readiness



Challenge

Choose a base word of your own. Add **-ness** and write a sentence with the new word.

Adding **-ness** turns
an adjective into a noun
that shows a state or quality!

